



△ Decoration on the Gates of Shalmaneser III, Nimrud

863 BCE

## NIMRUD BECOMES ASSYRIAN CAPITAL

The Neo-Assyrian Empire strengthened in the 9th century BCE. When Ashurnasirpal II became king, he embarked on a ruthless campaign of expansion, restoring Assyria to its former glory and power. He moved his capital from Assur to Nimrud (also known as Kalhu) where he built opulent palaces. After his death, his son Shalmaneser III enthusiastically continued in his father's footsteps.

872 BCE **The Temple of Luxor**, Egypt, is inundated by severe flooding of the Nile

836 BCE **Civil war breaks out in Egypt** after a power struggle between factions of the royal family

801 BCE



△ The Great Pyramid, La Venta

c. 900 BCE

## OLMEC CULTURE MOVES TO LA VENTA

After the Olmec city at San Lorenzo was badly damaged, perhaps by environmental change, its inhabitants set up a new centre in La Venta, about 75 km (45 miles) to the northeast. The new city was built on a grand scale, with paved roads, and dominated by a massive clay pyramid. Among the numerous artefacts discovered by archaeologists are ceremonial jade axes, sculpture, and pottery.

c. 850 BCE **The Kingdom of Van**

(in modern Armenia) asserts its independence from the Assyrian Empire under the reign of King Arame of Urartu

c. 814 BCE

## FOUNDING OF CARTHAGE

Legend surrounds the founding of the city of Carthage by the Phoenicians on the coast of present-day Tunisia. The most enduring account is that of Dido (or Elissa) from Tyre, who purchased the land and became its first queen. What is not in doubt, however, is that it evolved from a Phoenician colony into a thriving city-state, the capital of a powerful Carthaginian Empire.

▷ Carthaginian clay protome

